Benefits Realization Plan

ASM (Attack Surface Management)

Version: 1.1
GCdocs #:

1 Purpose

The purpose of this document is to provide a structured approach for the active identification, management and realization of benefits. This plan identifies who will be responsible for the change and who will be impacted by it. It also identifies how the impact will be measured and what activities need to be planned to realize the benefits. This document will ensure ownership and accountability for benefits realization throughout the Project lifecycle and beyond.

A Benefits Realization Plan is a specific requirement of the Treasury Board's *Directive on the Management of Projects and Programmes*. A finalized version must be completed for Gate 2 Approval and the content of the plan should be validated at each subsequent gate.

Table 1: Project or programme summary

Project Name	ASM (Attack Surface Management)
Project description	SSC faces the challenge of managing and reducing the GC's attack surface while strengthening its infrastructure against ever-evolving cyber threats. Additionally, the rapid adoption of new technologies and interconnected systems has resulted in an expanded attack surface that requires proactive management and defensive strategies. Through Treasury Board of Canada Secretariat (TBS), the ASM project has secured funding to become a critical component in fortifying the GC's cybersecurity posture. The project will procure and deploy three capabilities designed to shift SSC from a reactive to a proactive approach: **1. Attack Surface Management** The ASM capability will provide visibility into all external-facing assets by: • detecting external-facing assets across SSC's IT infrastructure; • mapping potential attack surfaces; and • providing prioritized, actionable intelligence to support SSC's remediation and mitigation activities. **2. Vulnerability Management** The VM capability will focus on internal infrastructure assessment by: • identifying internal assets and vulnerabilities across SSC's IT infrastructure; • mapping potential attack surfaces; and

	• providing prioritized, actionable intelligence to support SSC's remediation and mitigation activities. **3. Continuous Security Controls Assessment – Breach and Attack Simulation** capability will assess and validate the effectiveness of implemented security controls by: • continuous testing of the networks through simulated threat actor attacks; • deploying rapid retesting after simulated attacks to validate effectiveness of recent changes; • delivering critical insights into alerts, detections and security processes; and • providing proactive vulnerability management through drift analysis. Each capability will be deployed using a phased, iterative approach, starting with, then VM and finally. Within each phase, deployments will begin with small-scale implementations, enabling SSC to deliver value in shorter timeframes, align with organizational priorities and external risk factors and validate effectiveness before full-scale rollout.
Business Owner	
Project Sponsor	
Departments/ agencies	The following stakeholders are affected by each business outcome. Internal SSC Stakeholders: External Stakeholders:
Strategic alignment	This project supports several GC Digital Standards and Government of Canada priorities, including: **Address Security Risks**: The implementation of these three capabilities enhances and strengthens the Government of Canada's overall cybersecurity posture.

	Iterate and Improve Frequently: By continuously evolving its cybersecurity approach, SSC is taking proactive steps to maintain and advance its enterprise-level cyber resilience. **Collaborate Widely**: As part of the GC's IT Security, SSC collaborates with to define cybersecurity requirements. SSC also actively engages with industry partners and cloud service providers to refine and expand enterprise cybersecurity solutions that meet GC needs. **Connectivity and Security Services**: These services are designed to be reliable and responsive, safeguarding the information of government departments, agencies, and Canadians. **Enterprise Security-Based IT Infrastructure**: This project delivers responsive, security-based IT infrastructure and services that meet the evolving needs of government departments and agencies. It also supports SSC's strategic focus on future investments in enterprise service delivery.

2 Benefits Overview

2.1 Summary of Benefits

Referring to the Benefits Dependency Map (see Appendix A), provide the following:

Table 2: Summary of benefits

Expected Benefit *(Benefit of the project to SSC)*	**Key Performance Indicator** *(The metrics used to determine if the Expected Benefits are being received)*	**Baseline**	**Target** *(End result of the project investment and timeframe)*	**Benefit Owner** *(Director-level)*
Enhanced Asset Discovery (ASM)	Number of known IT assets scanned externally (ASM)	# total external assets	~#total external assets (20% increase) by ASM Gate 5 Deployment.	
Credentialized asset scans (VM)	% of IT assets scanned with valid credentials (VM)	16%	~ 50% by VM Gate 5 Deployment.	
Improved monitoring and detection of cybersecurity vulnerabilities	Average time required to detect a new vulnerability of an affected asset	No data available	20% less time to detect new vulnerabilities following Gate 5 ASM, VM & deployment.	

Note: A more comprehensive table is found in the Benefits Realization Register (see Appendix B)

2.2 Transition Activities / dependencies (internal and external)

For each benefit that will be realized after project close-out (as indicated in section 2.1 of this document), transition activities and timelines must be identified.

It is common for benefits to be realized after a project has been formally closed and the new capabilities integrated into business operations for the Service Line. This section includes a summary of what needs to be in place operationally for benefits to be realized beyond the closure of a Project. An example is the hand-over or transition activities to the benefit owner(s) or other stakeholders at the end of the project.

Table 3: Transition activities

Transition Activities	Position accountable	Target end-date for realization
Benefits Register co-developed with representative from service lines	Project Manager	Jan 31, 2040

2.3 Roles and Responsibilities for Managing Benefits

The table below is a simplified version of the Roles and Responsibilities table in Section 3.3 of the Project Charter.

Table 4: Roles and responsibilities

Roles and Responsibilities	Name, Position, and Email

Business Owner: Generally at the ADM level, this is the executive accountable for realizing the benefits and business outcomes of the project	
Project Sponsor: the Director General in the Service Line branch responsible for the business outcomes of the project, as well as providing the business requirements	
PM&D Director General: The Director General within PM&D is responsible for delivery of the project.	
Project Manager: Project Manager (PM) is fully responsible for the successful completion of the project including the day-to-day management of the project	
Performance measurement and reporting: The person responsible for tracking and measurement of benefits, and for the provision of the performance measures related to the project.	
Project Steering Committees	Director Steering Committee (Monthly) DG Steering Committee (Monthly)
Benefit owner: Additional resource assigned under the accountability of the Business Owner to manage the realization of benefits within the service line	

2.4 Approvals

The undersigned confirm their role and responsibilities as stated in the benefits realization plan for the project.

Table 5: Approvals

Position	Signature	Date
Approved by Business Owner		

Connectivity and Security Services Branch (CSSB)		
Approved by Project Sponsor and Benefit Owner		
Last approved by FIMB/PMB		

3 Approval and Revision History

This section serves to control the development and distribution of revisions to the benefits realization plan.

Through the Benefits Health Assessments via the Project Governance Framework, the benefits outlined in this plan must be:

- **actively managed throughout the investment life cycle;**
- **reassessed at each major project gate; and**
- **re-evaluated prior to making any changes to scope, schedule or budget.**

Revisions to this plan must only be completed through approved versions listed in the table below.

Table 6: Approval and revision history

Version Number	Date of Approval	Author(s)	Description of Approval or Change
1.0			Development of initial BRP artefact
1.1			Update to new template

Appendix A – Benefits Dependency Map

Include a hyperlink the Benefits Dependency Map document in GCdocs.

GCdocs #	

The Benefits Dependency Map links project outputs to desired changes, and changes to their corresponding benefits. These benefits are then linked to outcomes and results at the departmental level. This is the first benefits artefact to be created and the starting point for any benefits discussion.

For more information on Benefits Dependency Maps, please refer to the BMP's SharePoint.

Appendix B – Benefits Register

Include a hyperlink to the Benefits Register in GCdocs.

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The Benefits Realization Register records all potential benefits and indicators identified during the Benefits Dependency mapping process. It is used to explain the justification and calculation of any metrics that will build the dashboards.

For more information on Benefits Dependency Maps, please refer to the BMP's SharePoint.